

The Women's Movement
– to 1920
&
Immigration – to 1920

The Women's Movement

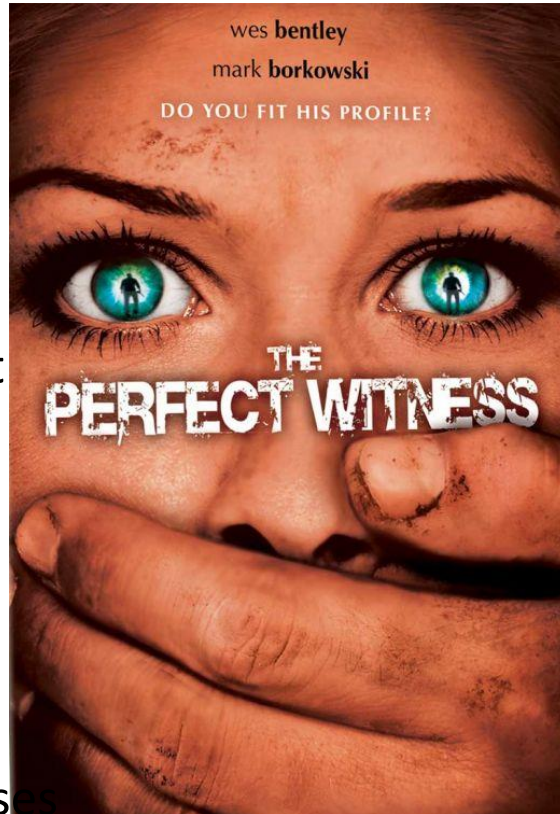


Picketing outside the White House, 1913

In the 19th century, American women



Could not testify in court



Could not sign as witnesses

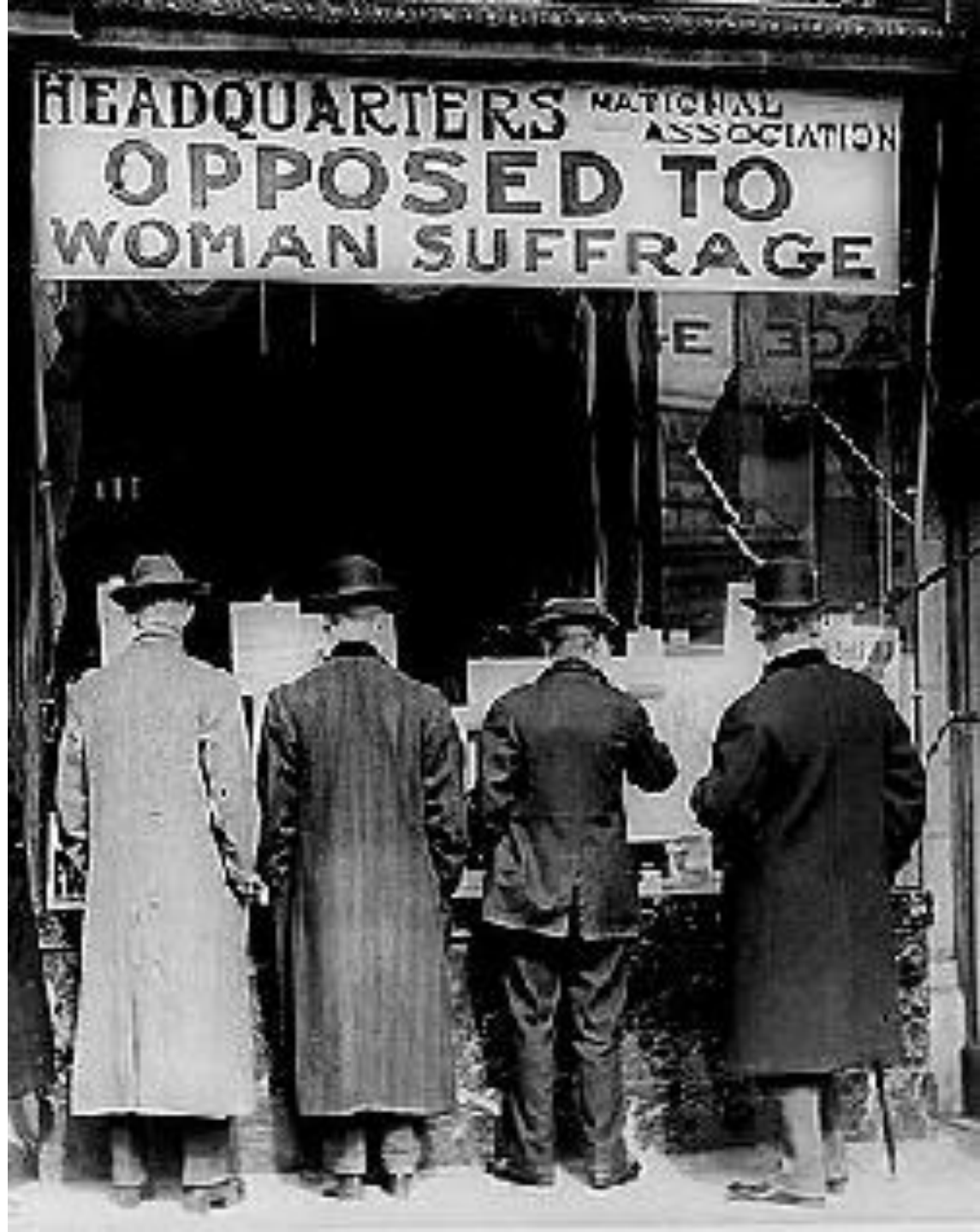


Could not hold title to property



Could not establish businesses

And they
could not
vote



First Women's Conference, Seneca Falls, 1848

George E. Washburn Section ~~VIII~~ *not*
Nov. 1848, Seneca Falls, N.Y.

No 16

THE FIRST CONVENTION

EVER CALLED TO DISCUSS THE

Civil and Political Rights of Women,

SENeca FALLS, N. Y., JULY 19, 20, 1848

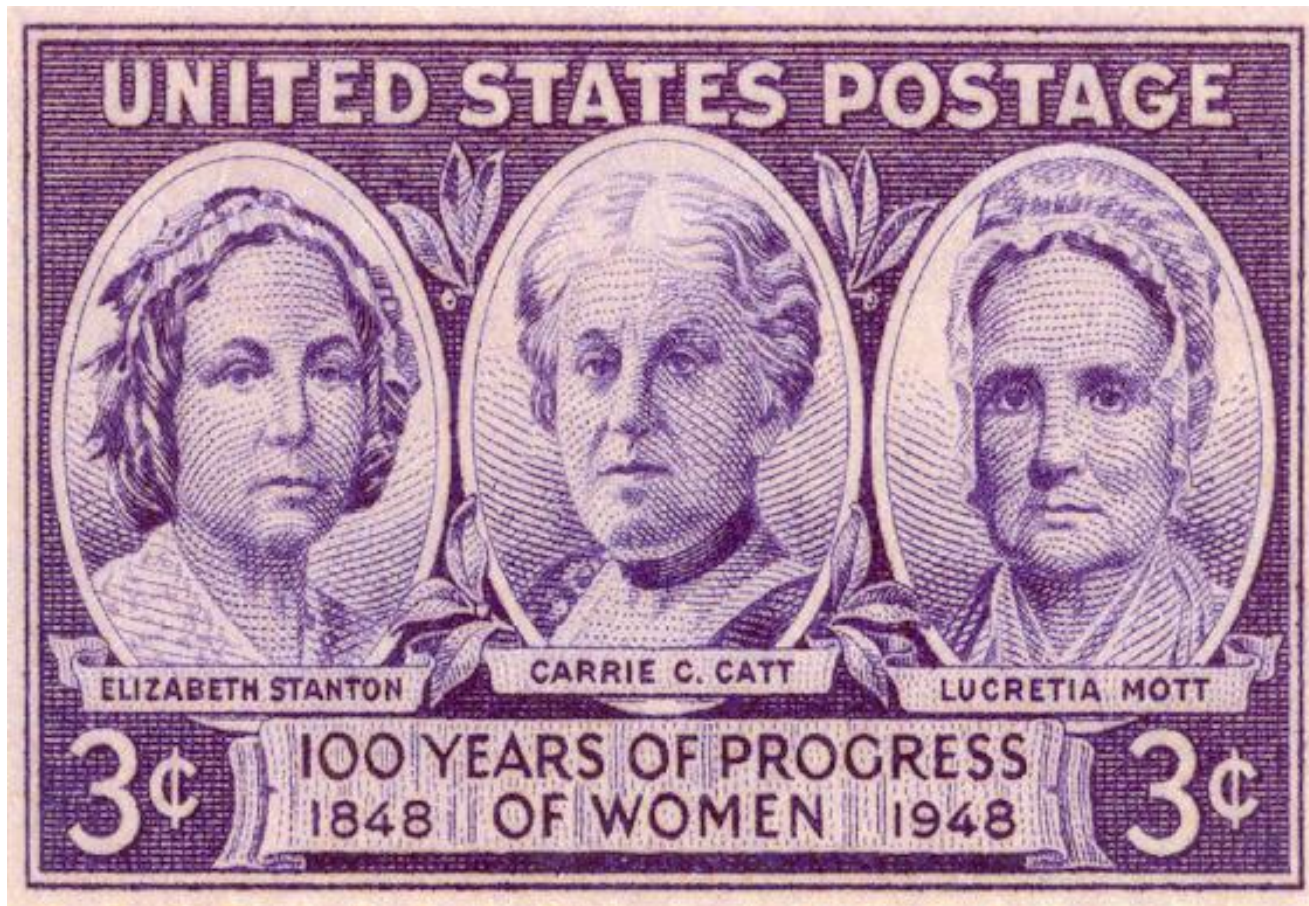
WOMAN'S RIGHTS CONVENTION.

A Convention to discuss the social, civil, and religious condition and rights of woman will be held in the Wesleyan Chapel, at Seneca Falls, N. Y., on Wednesday and Thursday, the 19th and 20th of July current; commencing at 10 o'clock A. M. During the first day the meeting will be exclusively for women, who are earnestly invited to attend. The public generally are invited to be present on the second day, when Lucretia Mott, of Philadelphia, and other ladies and gentlemen, will address the Convention.*

* This call was published in the *Seneca County Courier*, July 19, 1848, without any signature. The movers of this Convention, who drafted the call, the declaration and resolutions were Elizabeth Cady Stanton, Lucretia Mott, Maria C. Wright, Mary Ann McClintock, and Jane C. Burd.

Seneca Falls was radical

Rejected female inferiority;
sought **full gender equality**, not just suffrage;
suffrage was a MEANS to an end – which was full sexual equality.



Declaration:

“The history of mankind is a history of repeated injuries and usurpations on the part of man toward woman, having in direct object the establishment of an absolute tyranny over her.”

Iroquois Women

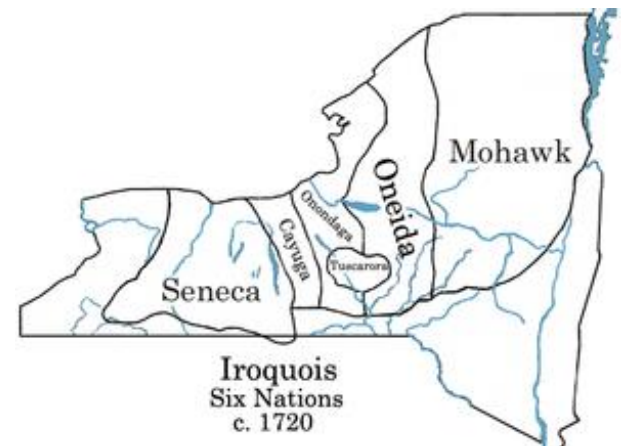
An Inspiration To Early Feminists



Elizabeth Cady Stanton marveled that “the women were the great power among the clan,” and “the original nomination of the chiefs also always rested with the women.”

Women of Iroquois “Six Nations”

[Haudenosaunee]
had power & vote;
influenced early
fight for women’s
rights



But Seneca Falls was conservative
in terms of race & class:
emphasizing equality of white middle class women



Race & Gender

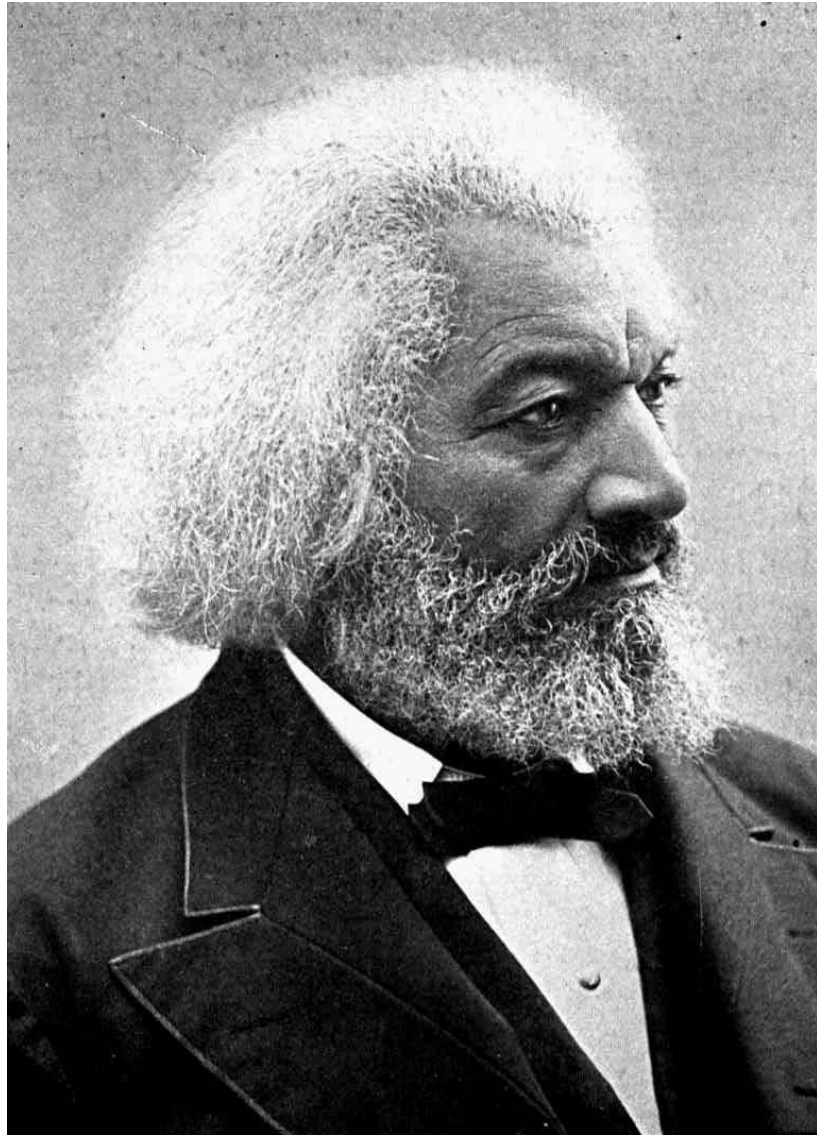
Before the civil war, those striving for black & women's rights cooperated.
But afterwards, there was a split.



**In 1869, Elizabeth Cady Stanton clashed with Frederick Douglass.
She was outraged that the 14th amendment restricted the
franchise to men.**

STANTON: “Shall American
statesmen ... so amend their
constitutions as to make their
wives and mothers the
political inferiors of unlettered
and unwashed ditch-diggers,
bootblacks, butchers and
barbers,
fresh from the slave
plantations of the South?”





DOUGLASS: "When women, because they are women, are hunted down through the cities of New York and New Orleans; when they are dragged from their houses and hung from lampposts; when their children are torn from their arms and their brains dashed out upon the pavement; when they are objects of insult and rage at every turn;

when they are in danger of having their homes burnt down ... then they will have an urgency to obtain the ballot

Schism: This led to a split in the Women's movement

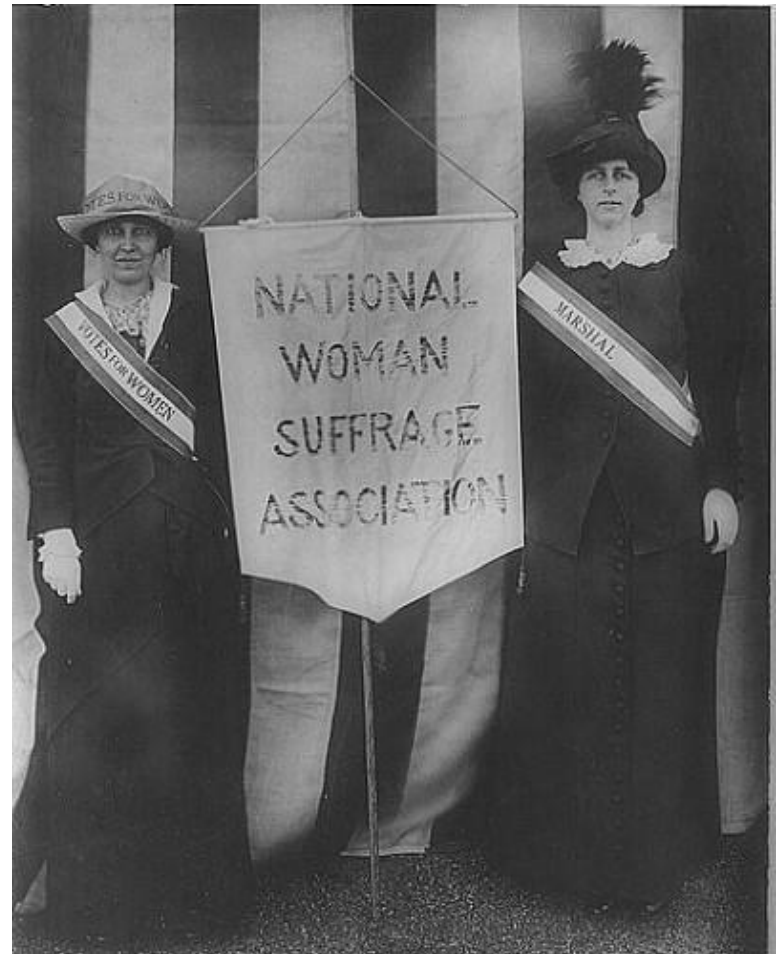


Susan B Anthony & Elizabeth Cady Stanton
National Woman Suffrage Association:
More radical re Women's rights



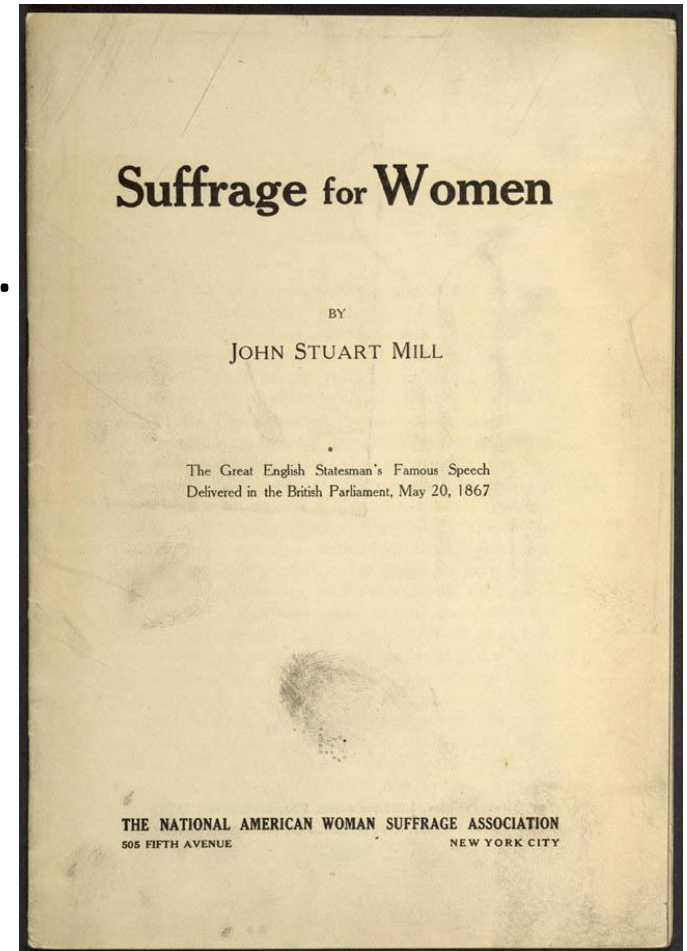
Lucy Stone
American Woman Suffrage Association

Finally resolved in
1890 with the
creation of National
American Woman's
Suffrage Association



NAWS much more narrow and conservative
than Seneca Falls (1848)

Emphasize suffrage not equality.
Base demand for vote not on justice,
but on idea that female suffrage
would "feminize" society.

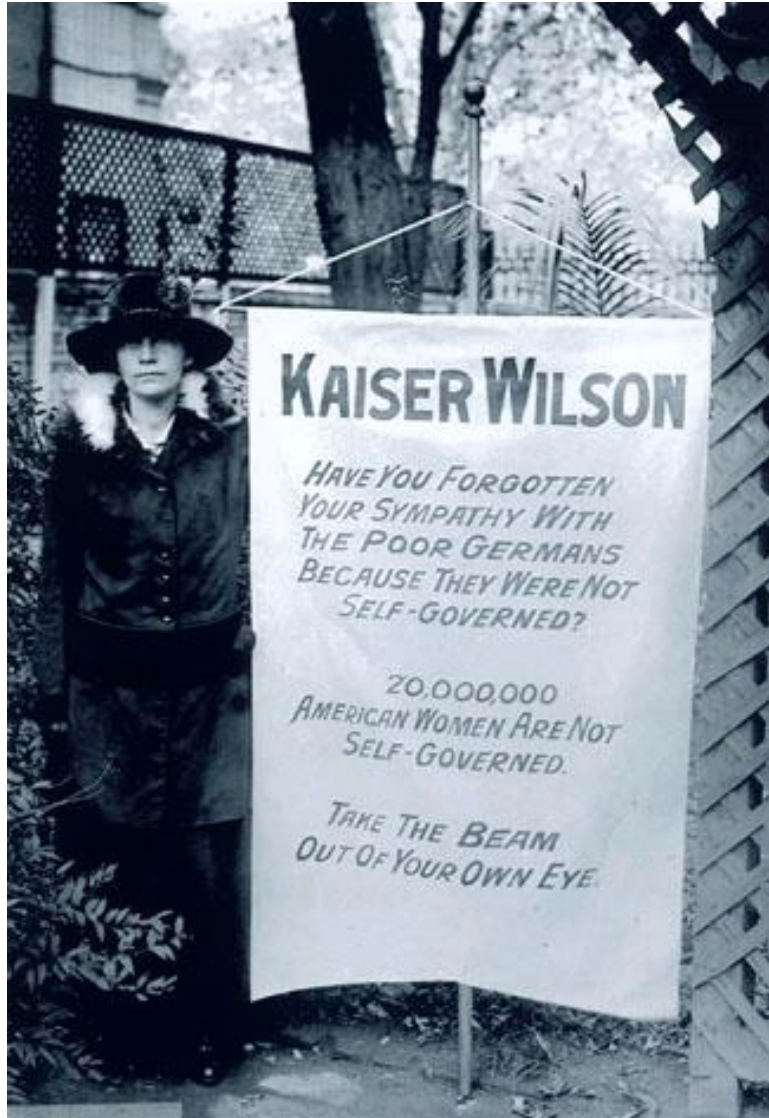


One Problem with NAWS: not inclusive.
Therefore, National Association of Colored
Women, 1896



Harriet Tubman and Ida B. Wells were among the founders of the NACW

Pressure on Wilson to Give Women the Vote, 1913-1919



- By 1912:
 - nine Western states allowed women to vote.
 - Bull Moose (Progressive Party), called for women's suffrage
- Importance of women's work in WW1





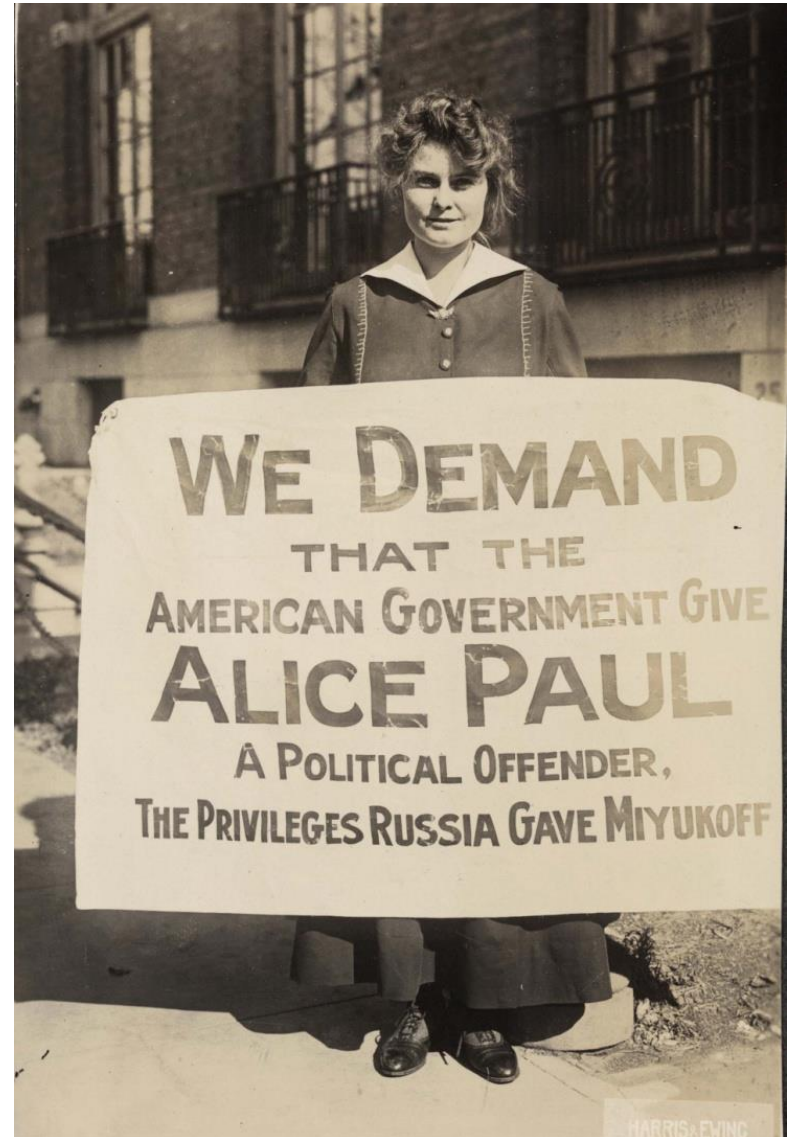
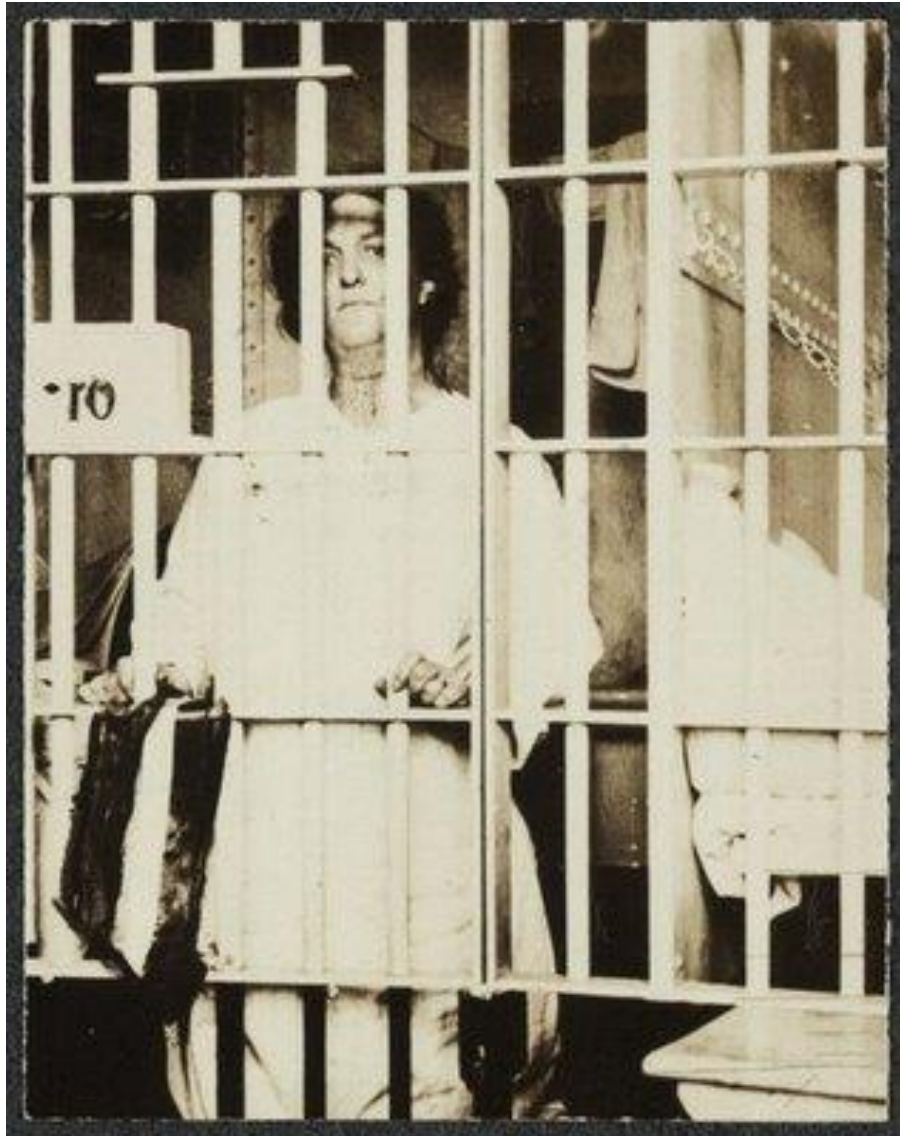
Lucy Benson

Many are jailed



Alice Paul

They are beaten & go on hunger strike



Women Get the vote! 19th Amendment, 1920



In 1919 – after World War One – President Wilson
Wilson supported women's suffrage



Alice Paul celebrates, 1920

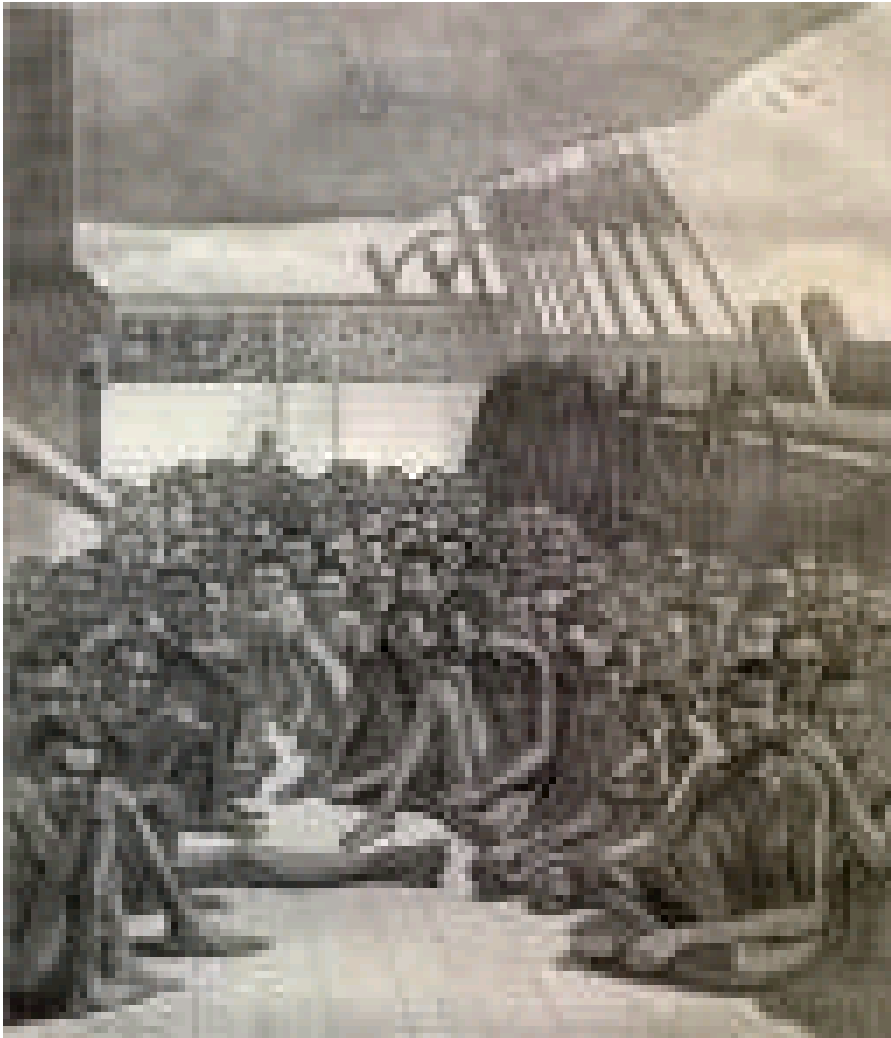
Godfather II

- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ubT-Bm36L2U>

IMMIGRATION



Don't forget the enslaved people:



until 1800s, most
“immigrants” –
approximately 10
million – were
from Africa.

Who comes to the United States?

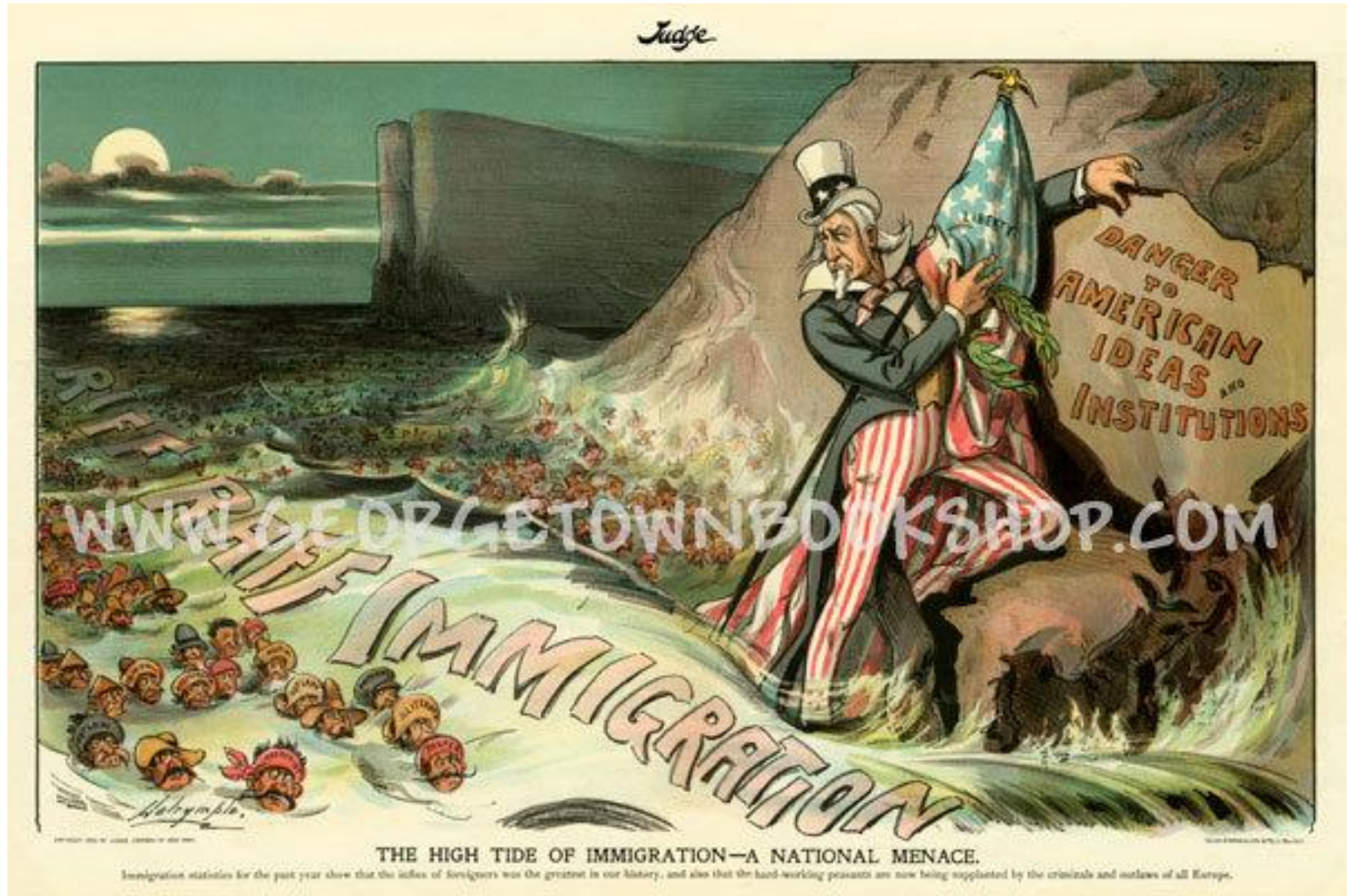
(1) The Best & Brightest

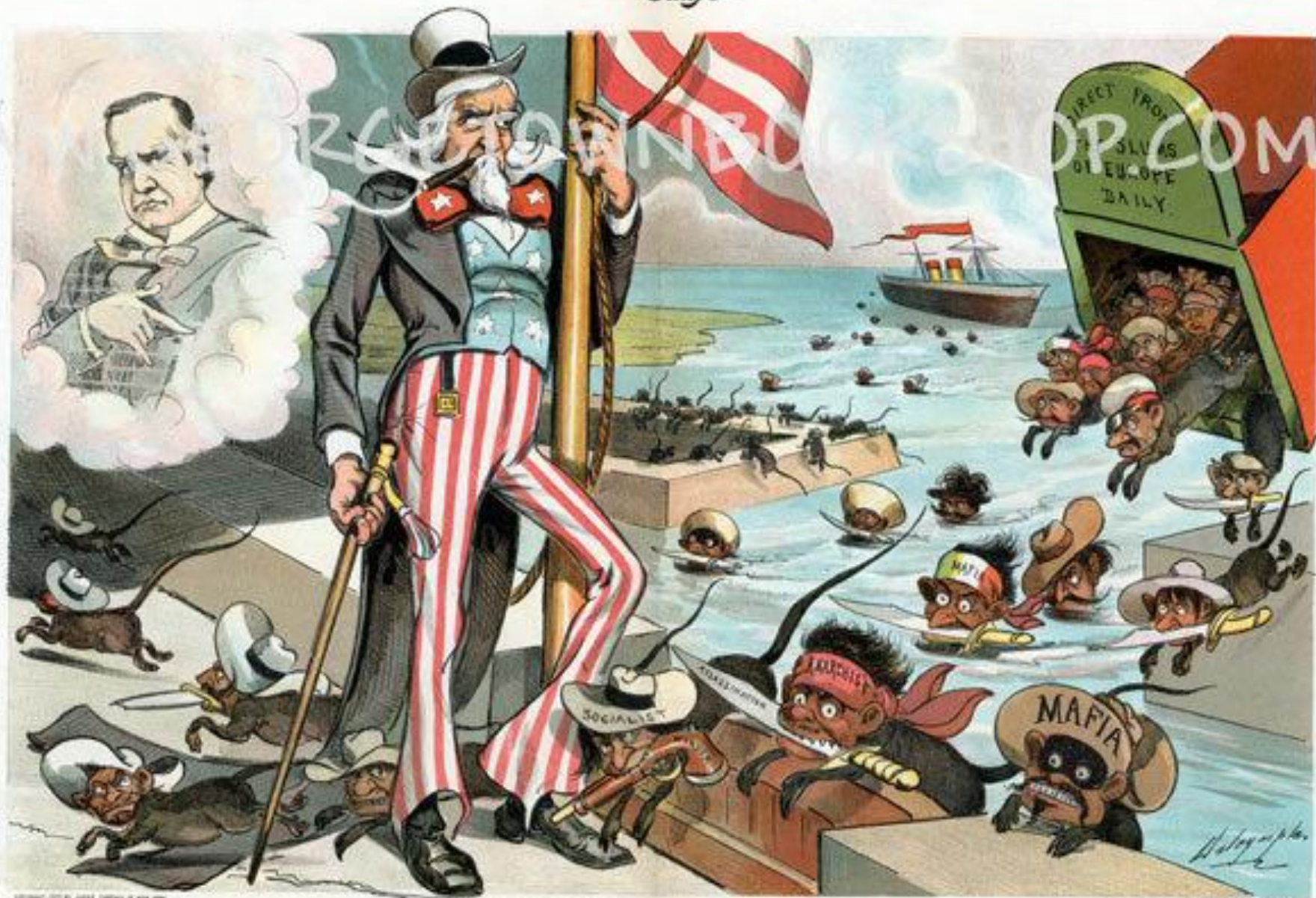
most energetic, entrepreneurial, and freedom-loving foreigners drawn to USA by magnet of US opportunity and liberty. They have helped make America #1.



Who comes to the USA? (2) the dregs

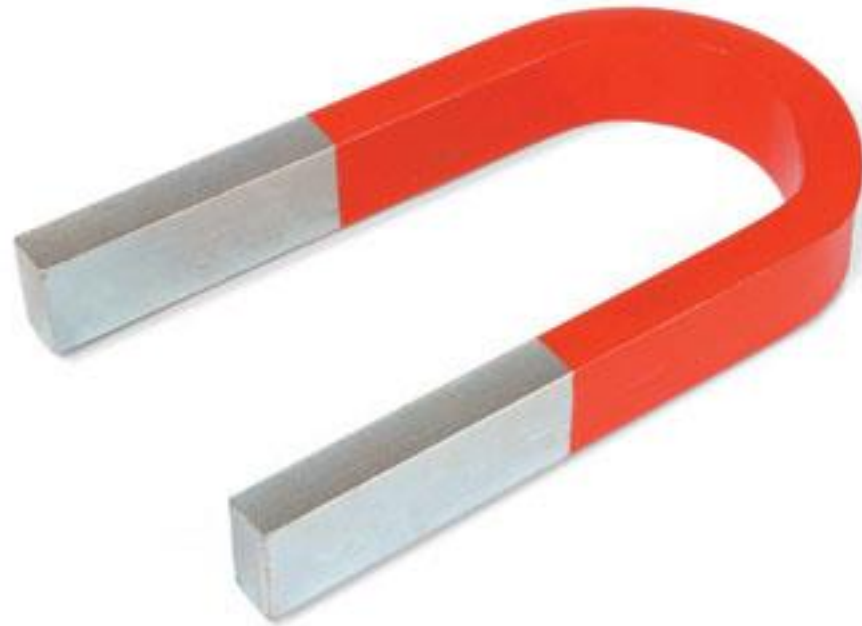
The new immigrants will debase American culture





THE UNRESTRICTED DUMPING-GROUND.

The US is seen as a magnet
that **pulls** immigrants
– the best & the dregs –
to its shores.

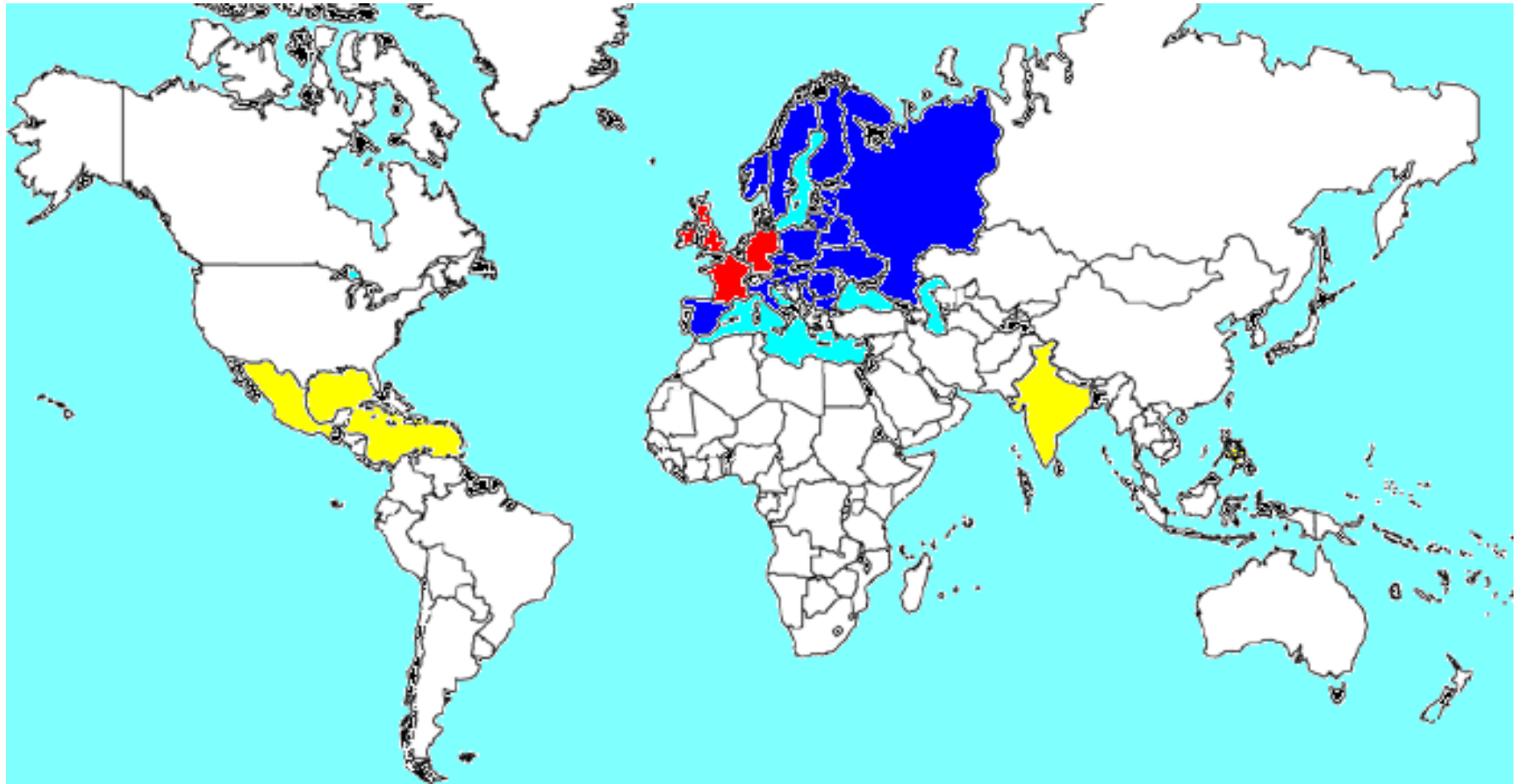


However, is this the full story?

Some puzzles: (1) Is US such a magnet, why did 40% of 19th century immigrants return home?



Puzzle (2): Immigrants have come in 3 waves



Pre 1880 – Northern Europe

1880-1920 – south & east Europe

Today: Mexico, Dominican Republic, India, Philippines, Russia

If immigrants are pulled to the United States because of the promise of a better life...

Why didn't Mexicans (for example) come in enormous numbers in 19th century?

What is the other part of the puzzle

The pull of the magnet ...



and



... social disruption at home

- Immigration is painful and difficult. Most people prefer to stay home.



They are “**pushed**” by crises at home.

Famine, Persecution, War



and the Industrial Revolution



Displacement, and overpopulation

How were immigrants treated?



The good news:
Despite difficulties,
most immigrants
assimilated with
remarkably little
discord.

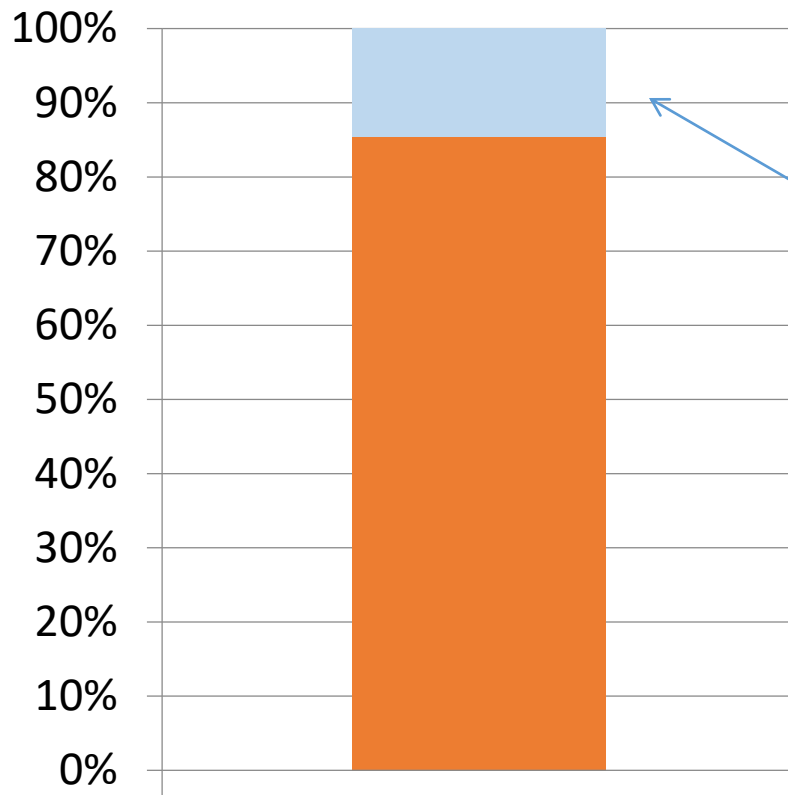
In part due to:
(1) Idea of the
melting pot

Immigrants --
diverse & widely
dispersed; tended
not to keep old
culture (and
language) intact
for more than a
few generations.



1889, *Puck*

Puck, June 16, 1889



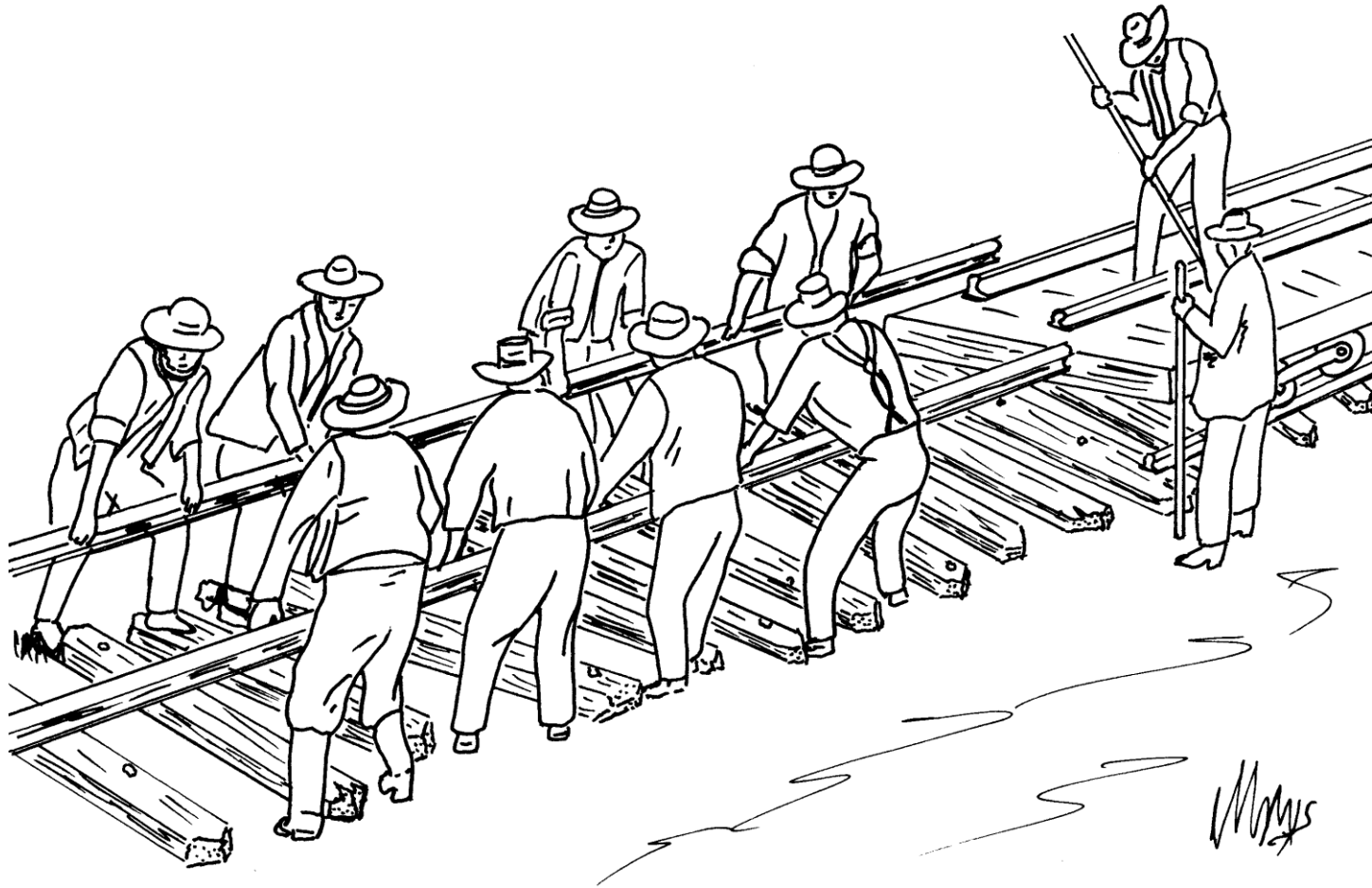
1910

(2) Never a high % of population. Peak, 1910, at 14.7%.
(Australia was 17% and Canada was 20+% in 1910.)

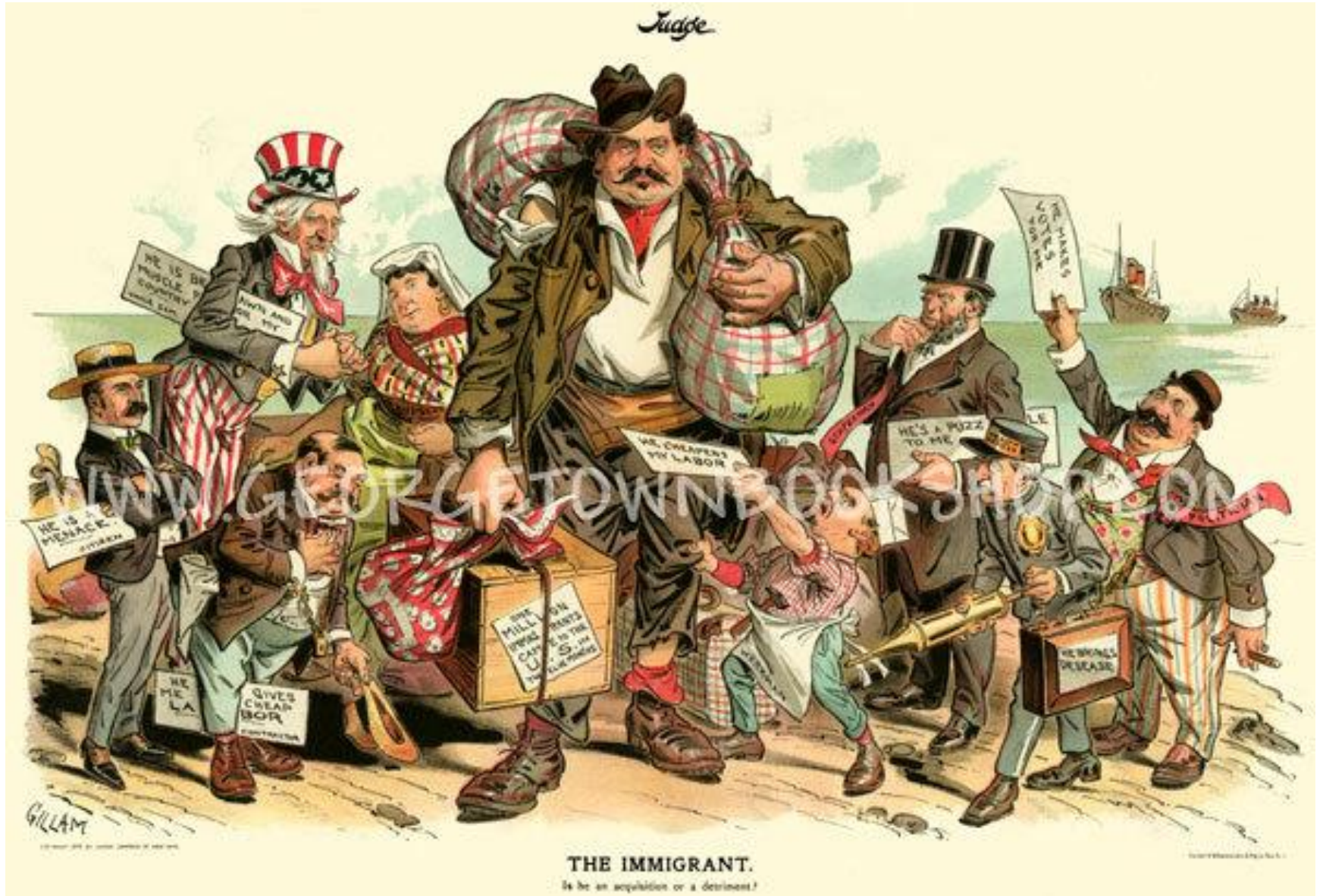
~13.5% today

Low was ~5% in 1970

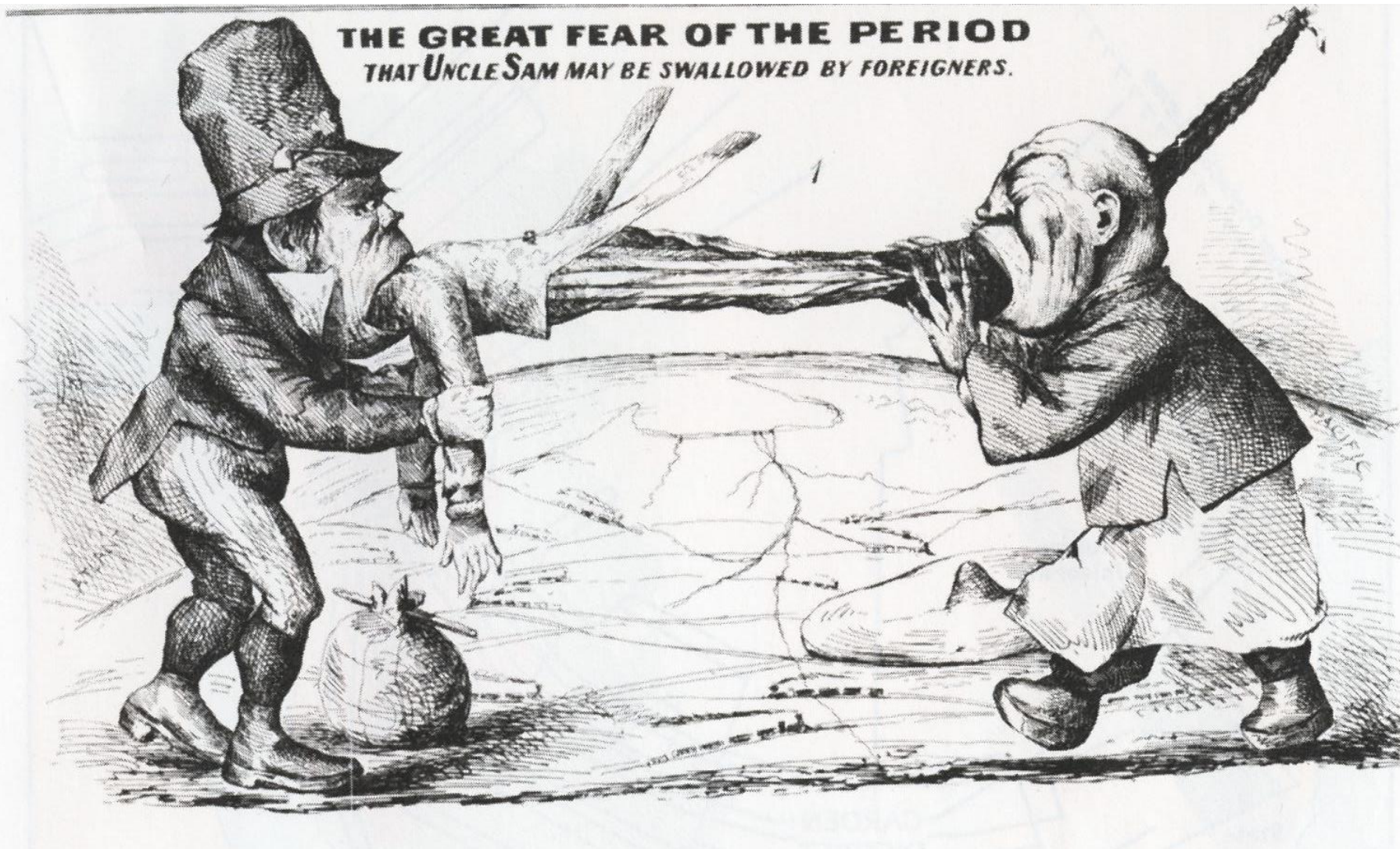
(3) Immigrants supplied needed labor



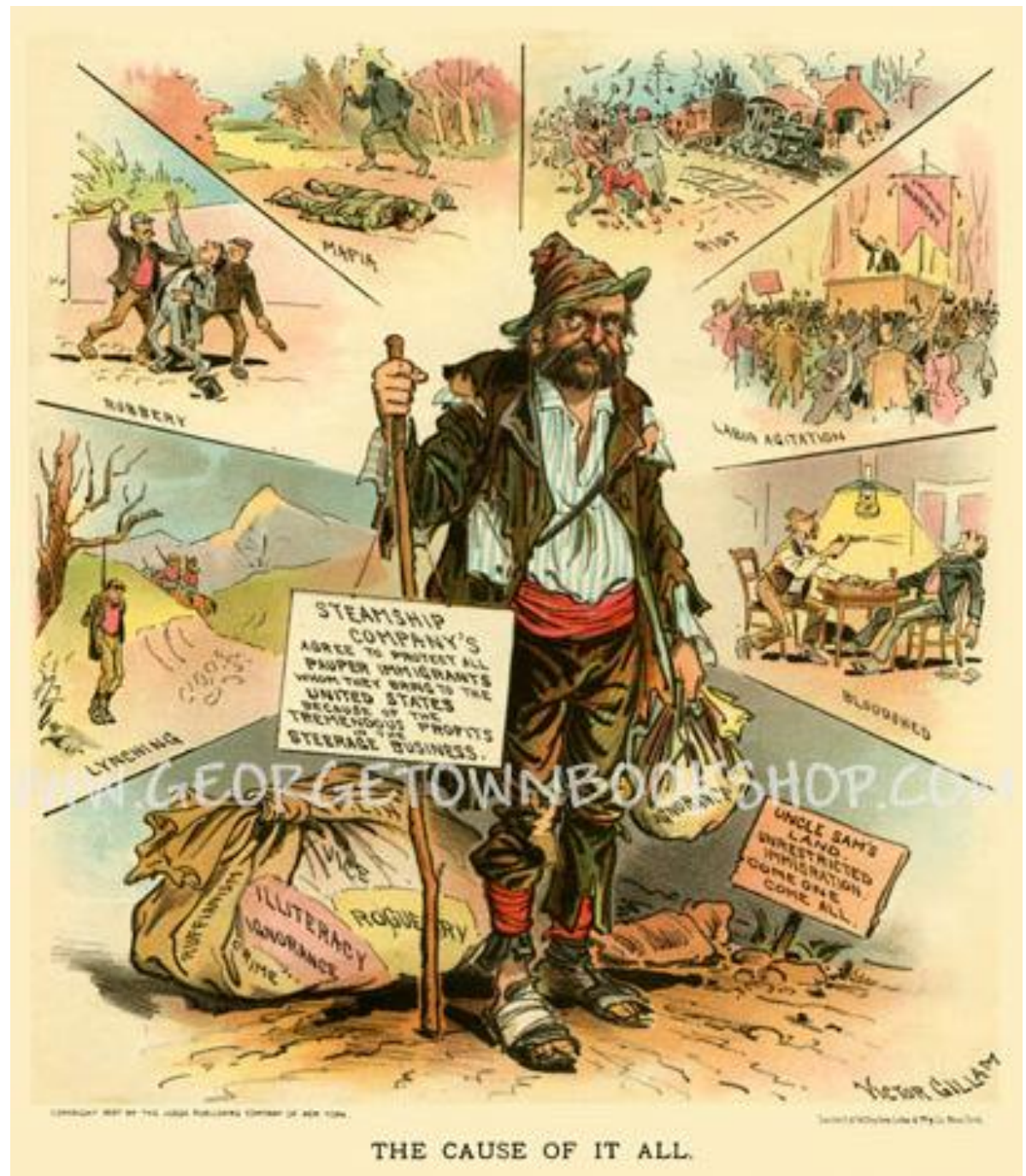
But they were greeted with Mixed Feelings



In 1860s, rise of “nativism” due to
(1) racism, especially vs. Chinese



and
“swarthy”
east & south
Europeans





A STATUE FOR *OUR* HARBOR.

Nativism due to
(2) fear of
competition for
jobs

Nativism due
to (3) fear of
corruption of
American
culture,
especially,
fear of
radicalism



Nativists called for the government to restrict immigration

- Boston Anti-immigration League, 1905: "We call on the government to exclude the illiterate and require a high physical standard, since immigration is more and more coming from regions of a low physical standard, whose incapacity for self-government is being made visible."
- Another anti-immigrant in 1905 spoke of "the great bulk of immigration now pouring in it like a mighty tide of polluted water..."

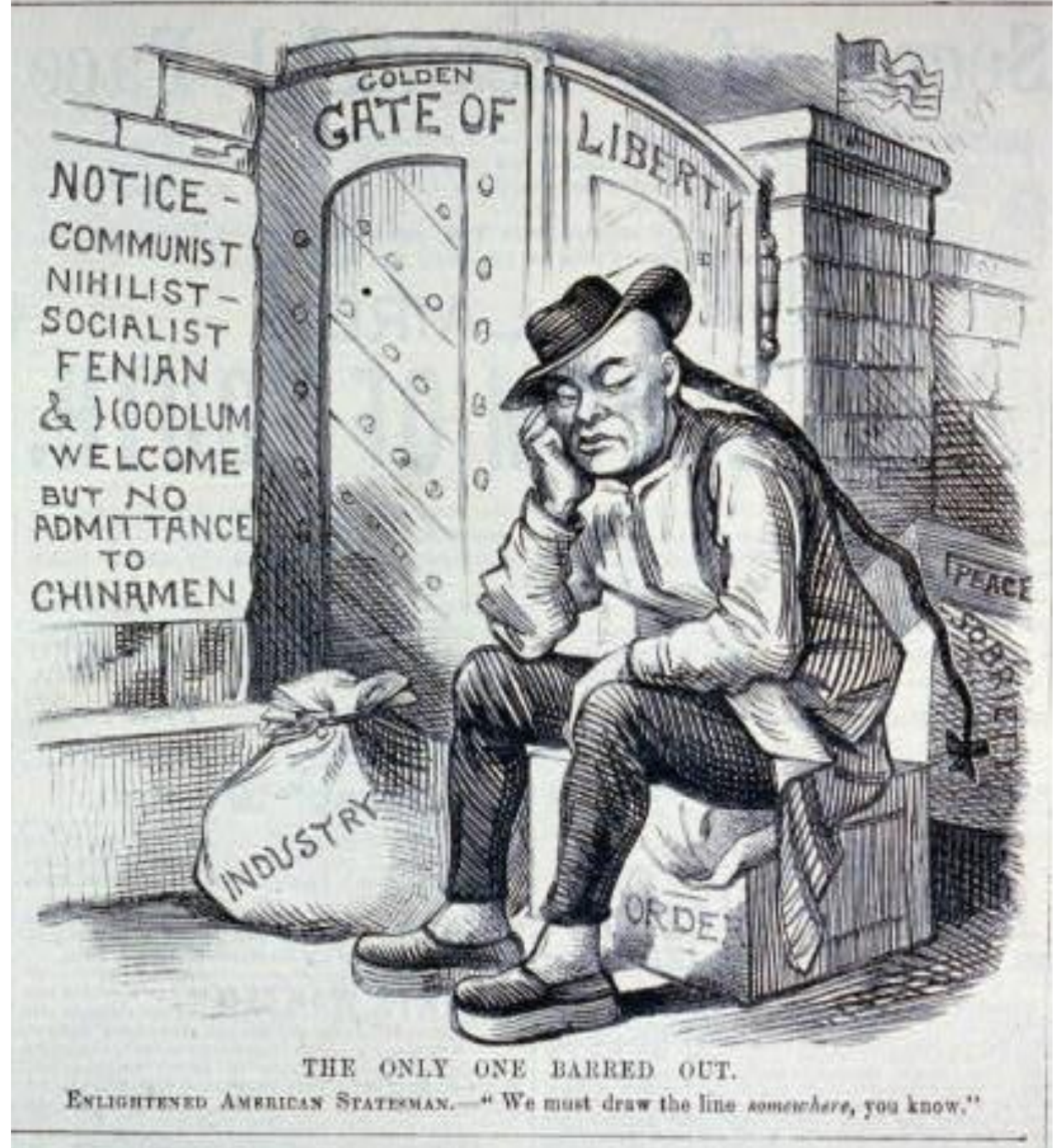
What laws governed immigration?

1776-1790: no restrictions

1790: Naturalization Act: "any alien, being a free **white** person, may be admitted to become a citizen of the United States."

Excluded Indians, free blacks, enslaved people, indentured servants (of any race), and (later) Asians

1882: Chinese Exclusion Act



Ellis Island opened 1891. Federal Government assumed responsibility for processing immigrants



In the first
decades of
the 20th
century,
nativist
sentiment
grew
stronger

